County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Thursday, April 9, 2026
9:00 AM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 9:00 AM

PRESENT
Chair Alice Howard,
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Joseph Passiment

ABSENT
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Chair Howard led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 8:0.

5. Public Comment Period

No public comments were taken.

6. Chief Financial Officer Update

Chief Financial Officer Pinky Harriott explained to council whom they would be hearing from this morning and urged them to keep in mind the directives they have already given administration to fund a COLA, the step program, retiree gap insurance, and the detention center pay band. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full update **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

7. FY 2027 Elected Officials Budget Request Presentations

a. 14th Circuit Solicitor's Office Budget Request - Solicitor Duffie Stone

14th Circuit Solicitor Duffie Stone presented his office's FY27 budget request, asking Beaufort County to increase its per capita to $20.89. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

b. Beaufort County Sheriff's Office Budget Request - Beaufort County Sheriff P.J. Tanner

Suzanne Cook, Chief Financial Officer for the Beaufort County Sheriff's Office, presented the Sheriff's FY 27 Budget request, which is an 8.34% increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

c. Budget Requests from Other Elected Officials

Beaufort County Auditor David Cadd presented his office's FY27 Budget Request, asking County Council for a 2.51% increase to cover the printing costs that were taken from his budget without his knowledge.

Probate Judge Heather Galvin presented her office's FY27 Budget Request asking County Council for a 1.43% decrease in her budget from FY26. She mentioned working to expand the Hilton Head Island office to better serve the public.

Beaufort County Master in Equity Jim Wegman presented his office's FY27 Budget Request, asking County Council for a 1.27% budget increase from FY26 to help improve the AV system in their office and courtroom.

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full requests. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

8. FY 2027 Outside Agency Budget Request Presentations

a. Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Budget Presentation - Gene Zapfel, KBCB Chair

Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Chair Gene Zapfel presented their FY27 Budget Request asking County Council for a 360% increase to cover the cost of new signage, a rice trunk memorial to honor the historical aspect rice trunks play in our heritage, recycling initiatives, and new plantings. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

b. Small Business Association Budget Presentation - Martin Goodman, Area Manager

Beaufort Area Small Business Association Manager Martin Goodman presented the FY27 Budget Request, asking County Council for a 0% increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

c. Hilton Head Island Recreation Association Budget Presentation - Leah Arnold, Parks and Recreation Executive Director

Hilton Head Island Recreation Center Director... presented their FY27 Budget request, asking County Council for a 15.15% increase to help cover the cost of the pool. They are the only public pool on Hilton Head Island, and their funding request is $200,000. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

d. Lowcountry Regional Transportation Authority Budget Presentation - Kristine Hepburn, Director of Finance and Administration

Lowcountry Regional Transportation Authority Director Mary Lou Franzoni presented their FY27 Budget Request and are asking County Council for a 55.80% budget increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851

e. Beaufort Conservation District Budget Presentation - Denise Parsick, Commissioner Chair

Beaufort Conservation District Commissioner Chair Denise Parsick presented their FY27 Budget Request and asked County Council for a zero percent increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851

f. Military Enhancement Committee Budget Presentation - Col Warren Parker, MEC Chair

Military Enhancement Committee Chair Col. Warren Parker presented their FY27 Budget Request, asking County Council for a zero percent increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851**

g. Coastal Empire Community Mental Health Center Budget Presentation - Dr. Jennifer Cobb-Hayes, Director of Administration, Safety Officer, and Performance Improvement Officer

Coastal Empire Community Mental Health Center Executive Director Angie Salley presented their FY27 Budget Request and are asking County Council for a 100.76% increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851

h. Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation Budget Presentation - John O'Toole, Executive Director

Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation Executive Director John O'Toole presented their FY27 Budget Request and is asking County Council for a zero percent increase from FY26. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full request.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381851

9. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY



BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: April 27, 2026